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THE ANGRY TIDE

INDIA AGAINST CORRUPTION, 2011

Pan-India



▼ A supporter carries a giant Anna poster at Jantar Mantar where the social activist was on hunger strike, Aug. 24, 2011

EPA/ANINDITO MUKHERJEE

The India Against Corruption (IAC) movement was a series of protests across India in 2011 against political corruption. It was sparked off by a number of leading politicians in the-then UPA government being embroiled in corruption cases. The movement was launched when the government proved reluctant to submit to the growing demand for a national anti-corruption watchdog–the Lok Pal–with the authority to investigate political corruption. Student participation strengthened it immensely, turning it into a mass movement.

The movement gained momentum from April 5, 2011, when activist Anna Hazare began a hunger strike at Jantar Mantar in New Delhi. Hazare's fasts, the support from traditional media and the astute use of social media by IAC leaders drew India's urban middle classes on to the streets. It resulted in the Centre involving some of the activists in the formulation of an anti-corruption bill. Some protest leaders launched the Aam Aadmi Party, which is now in power in Delhi. ■

–Kaushik Deka

POWER OF PROTEST The IAC movement not only caused a massive awakening about corruption in India but also showed that popular protests can shake the corridors of power